This was more fun, and we maintained our momentum in the Test series, comfortably winning the first Test in Trinidad after we dismissed the home team for 102, drawing the second Test on a flat wicket in St Kitts and sealing the 2–0 series win with a clinical victory in Barbados.

I enjoyed every minute of the tour, hitting the ball consistently well and scoring 102, 41, 70, 57 not out and 13 in the ODI series, followed by 68, 19 not out, 135 not out, 31 not out, 73 and 4 not out in the Test matches. It felt great to be in decent nick, although this success was punctuated by a moment of acute embarrassment during the second Test.

My stomach had begun to rumble as I took my score into the 80s. I wanted to play through the distress but there was no avoiding the anatomical reality that I would need to leave the field and take a toilet break, even though such events are unusually rare in international cricket. I was facing Sulieman Benn. Feeling increasingly pressed for time, I drove to the sweeper on the cover boundary for two, swept a boundary and then reached my tenth Test century with a straight drive into the crowd. Two defensive prods later, at the end of the over, I sheepishly told the umpire I was sorry for any inconvenience, but I really did need to spend some time in the pavilion.

The match had to be stopped for five or six minutes while I left the field – much to the amusement of both players and spectators who seemed to realise what was happening. The general situation was certainly not helped by some of my teammates, who chose to throw a toilet roll at me when I emerged from the pavilion to resume my innings.

Our success in the Caribbean was followed by impressive T20 and ODI series wins at home to Zimbabwe, and spirits within the Proteas squad could hardly have been higher. Since being eliminated from the World Twenty20 with a whimper, we had played 18 international matches in the five and a half months between Wednesday 19 May and Friday 29 October and not lost once, winning 17 games and only drawing the Test in Barbados.